MESSMAP

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT (BRD)

1. Business Overview

MessMap is a location-based web application that connects students with local mess services. Students can discover nearby messes and compare information such as menu, price, food type, operating hours, availability, location, contact details, and reviews. Mess owners can manage their mess information through a dashboard. Administrators oversee users, owners, mess listings, and reviews.

2. Business Problem

Students living in hostels, PGs, or rented accommodation may struggle to find affordable, suitable, home-style meals. Information found through word of mouth or general food platforms may be incomplete or outdated. Local mess owners may not have a dedicated online system to publish and update their services.

3. Business Objectives

Provide one central platform for discovering local mess services.

Help students find and compare messes using location, price, food type, meal availability, and ratings.

Display useful and current mess information, including daily/weekly menus, prices, timings, and temporary closures.

Give mess owners a simple dashboard to maintain their profiles and service details.

Allow administrators to verify mess listings and manage users, owners, and reviews.

Make it easier for students to contact a mess or navigate to its location.

4. Stakeholders and User Roles

Stakeholder	Responsibility / Interest
Student/User	Finds nearby messes, views details, compares options, and submits reviews/ratings.
Mess Owner	Registers a mess and maintains its menu, pricing, timings, availability, and contact information.
Administrator	Verifies mess listings and manages platform users, owners, listings, and review content.
Project Team	Designs, develops, tests, deploys, and maintains the application.

5. Business Scope

5.1 In Scope

Student and mess-owner registration and login.

Role-based access for Student, Mess Owner, and Admin.

Mess profile submission and administrator verification.

Location-based mess discovery, search, and filters.

Mess detail pages containing menus, pricing, food type, timings, availability, contact details, and map/location.

Owner dashboard for updating mess information.

Student ratings and reviews.

Admin dashboard for managing users, owners, mess listings, and reviews.

5.2 Out of Scope for the Initial Version

Online meal ordering, delivery tracking, and delivery-person management.

Online payments, subscriptions, refunds, or payment gateway integration.

Automatic booking of seats or meals.

Chat or real-time messaging between students and owners.

AI-based food recommendations. These may be considered in a future version.

These exclusions are proposed scope boundaries for the first version; the project team can revise them if the guide or project plan requires additional features.

6. Business Rules

A user must log in to access role-specific dashboard features.

A mess owner can create and edit only the mess listing associated with their account.

A newly submitted mess listing must remain pending until an administrator approves or rejects it.

Only approved and active mess listings should appear in student search results.

A rejected listing should show its status to the owner and allow correction and resubmission.

Owners are responsible for keeping menu, price, timings, and availability information current.

A review must be associated with a student account and a mess listing.

Administrators can take action on invalid listings, users, or inappropriate review content.

7. Success Measures

Students can search and open details for approved mess listings.

Search filters return results matching the selected criteria.

Owners can update information and see the saved changes reflected on the student-facing page.

Unapproved listings are not publicly discoverable.

Users cannot access features that belong to a different role.

The application gives clear messages when input is invalid or a request fails.

8. Assumptions and Dependencies

Users have an internet connection and a supported modern browser.

Location-based search depends on browser location permission or a manually selected location.

Map functionality depends on a selected map/geocoding provider and its API availability, limits, and configuration.

Email verification or registration emails are not assumed unless the team explicitly includes an email service.

Exact review eligibility rules, account-blocking rules, and verification evidence must be finalized by the project team.